



King County Library System

Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes

KCLS Service Center/Hybrid | June 25, 2025, 5pm

Present

KCLS Board

Crystal Goodwin
Jeff Guddat
Srini Raghavan
Verna Seal*
Lalita Uppala
Laura Valenziano

KCLS Staff

Maria Bassett
Jen Baxter
Angie Benedetti
BJ Colvin
Heidi Daniel
Lisa Fraser
Chase Gallagher
Angie Miraflor
Dominica Myers
Danielle Perry
Cecie Streitman
Lisa Yamasaki
Donna Zirkle

**attended remotely*

Motions Approved

1. Board Meeting agenda
2. May 28, 2025 Board meeting minutes
3. Payroll expenditures
4. General Fund expenditures

Call to Order

President Laura Valenziano called the meeting to order at 5:04pm. Verna Seal, Srini Raghavan, Crystal Goodwin, Jeff Guddat, and Lalita Uppala were in attendance in person; Verna Seal attended remotely. There was a quorum.

Approval of Agenda

Verna Seal moved approval of the Board Meeting agenda. Jeff Guddat seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.

Approval of Board Minutes

Lalita Uppala moved approval of the May 28, 2025 Board Meeting minutes. Srini Raghavan seconded the motion. All voted in favor and the motion passed unanimously.

Public Forum

There was no public comment.

Finance and Facilities Report

Finance and Facilities Director Donna Zirkle presented the monthly Finance report as of the end of May 2025. Year-to-date (YTD) revenues were \$79.1M, against the yearly revenue budget of \$150.6M, which was approximately 53%. YTD expenses were \$61.8M, which is 38% of the total expense budget of \$164.6M. CIP expenses YTD at the end of May were \$1.4M, accounting for 11% of the total budget of \$12.5M.

As of the end of May, revenues and expenses were expected to be at approximately 42% of the total annual budget, which originally projected a \$14 million year-end deficit. However, there are positive financial developments:

- A \$1.9 million surplus resulting from a bond close-out
- Approximately \$3 million in vacancy savings



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Executive Director Heidi Daniel provided a brief update on the central sorter project. In response to thoughtful questions raised during the April 2025 Board meeting, the project team reevaluated key assumptions and collaborated with the sorter manufacturer, Lyngsoe Systems. As a result, a new design was developed with a projected cost of \$4.9 million—a reduction of \$2 million from the previous estimate.

The updated design maintains the original functionality and is capable of processing the current volume of 35,000 materials per day. The team is continuing to evaluate potential locations to house the new unit.

Approval of Monthly Expenditures

Crystal Goodwin moved approval of Payroll expenditures for May in the amount of \$3,464,841.94:

(5/09) Ck#00202384-00202399; Ck#945491402-945492538; (5/23) Ck#00202400-00202414;

Ck#952538353-952539489. **Verna Seal seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.**

Jeff Guddat moved approval of General Fund #0010 expenditures for May in the amount of

\$7,714,203.82: Travel Advances – 1548-1549; (5/08) Ck#1159585-1159704; 5015444-5015448; (5/15)

Ck#1159705-1159837; 5015449-5015503; (5/22) Ck#1159838-1159931; 5015504-5015507; (5/30)

Ck#1159932-1160037; 5015508; (6/05) Ck#1160038-1160142; 5015509-5015514; Voids – Ck#1159964.

Lalita Uppala seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.

Staff and Director's Reports

Government Relations Update

John Sheller provided an overview of the political landscape in which the King County Library System operates, emphasizing the variety of jurisdictions and the importance of proactive engagement. As a publicly funded entity, KCLS serves a broad geographic area that includes multiple levels of government. The Library System employs a high-touch government relations approach, aiming to ensure that elected officials are well-informed about KCLS and recognize the value it provides to their constituents.

John briefly described each level of government and gave context for KCLS' interactions with them. The King County Council appoints the Board of Trustees; there are nine members of the council, eight of whom have jurisdiction over KCLS' service area. Executive Director Heidi Daniel has met with most of the council members.

There are 38 cities in KCLS' service area, and 35 of them have a King County Library. The three exceptions are Milton, which is served by the Pierce County Library System, and the two cities of Hunts Point and Yarrow Point, both of which chose not to receive library services. KCLS regional managers make annual



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presentations at city council meetings, and the system provides mayors with performance benchmarks to help illustrate the value and scope of services offered.

There are three tribes in the KCLS service area: the Muckleshoot, Snoqualmie and Puyallup tribes.

Forty-two state legislators represent districts that overlap with the KCLS service area. KCLS actively engages with these lawmakers during the legislative session. This year, Heidi visited Olympia twice and submitted one piece of written testimony. The goal is to position KCLS as a valuable resource on legislation affecting libraries.

KCLS also maintains strong relationships with federal lawmakers, including U.S. Representatives. Suzan DelBene, Pramila Jayapal, Kim Schrier and Adam Smith. The two U.S. senators from Washington also have good rapport with KCLS, although their schedules allow for less direct contact.

Recent changes at the federal level have resulted in the withdrawal of funding for the Climate Action Plan grant. Additionally, the future of E-Rate funding—a critical source of support for library technology access—remains uncertain.

Information Technology Services (ITS) Update

ITS Director BJ Colvin provided an update on a range of initiatives currently underway within the Information Technology Services Department.

He began by highlighting several pilot projects aimed at enhancing patron and staff experiences:

- Charging lockers: Charging lockers have been installed at the Crossroads and Southcenter mall library locations, providing a secure option for patrons to recharge their devices.
- Hybrid meeting technology: A new amplification and hybrid meeting system is being piloted at the Bellevue Library, improving audio and virtual participation capabilities.
- Co-creation model: ITS is piloting a new technology co-creation model at three community libraries. In this model, ITS staff work directly with local library staff to identify community needs and collaboratively test and refine technology solutions tailored to those needs.

BJ reported on the development of a new internal-facing AI policy for KCLS staff. The policy is designed to ensure responsible and transparent use of artificial intelligence, with guiding principles including proper attribution of AI-generated content; required fact-checking to maintain accuracy; safeguarding of user and system data; and promotion of safe, ethical AI usage. The ITS team continues to test and evaluate new AI tools as part of this initiative.



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He also addressed broader issues of data privacy and the ongoing evaluation of infrastructure choices, including the relative merits of on-premise servers versus cloud-based storage solutions. He offered to conduct more detailed follow-up sessions with interested board members.

BJ provided an update on cybersecurity at KCLS. The ITS team recently collaborated with external consultants to conduct a tabletop cybersecurity exercise with the KCLS leadership team. This simulation introduced participants to three phases of a hypothetical cyberattack, and guided them through response protocols appropriate at each stage.

Due to the department's proactive approach and expertise, KCLS' cybersecurity insurance rates are decreasing, in contrast to rising rates across most sectors. Additional enhancements include the full implementation of immutable data backups, increased automation, and ongoing testing of response plans to ensure preparedness.

BJ concluded with updates on several forward-looking projects:

- Completion of a KCLS Foundation-funded research project aimed at improving content discoverability for patrons.
- Implementation of automated refunds for lost items that are later returned.
- Ongoing evaluation of e-reader options to expand access to digital materials.
- Development of a new patron request process to streamline and improve service delivery.

KCLS Foundation Update

Lisa Yamasaki, Executive Director of the KCLS Foundation, provided the Board with updates on recent and upcoming foundation activities.

Lisa reported that the foundation recently awarded nearly \$30,000 in Agility Grants to support a variety of library programs, including Summer Book Bingo, KCLS Friends Day, and the fall/winter adult literacy pilot.

The foundation is currently in the process of reviewing, approving and voting on this year's Advance Grant applications. A total of 18 applications were received, an increase from 15 the previous year. Applications reflect a diverse range of proposals, including initiatives in library innovation, literacy, services and outreach. Award announcements are expected on July 18.

Yamasaki highlighted the success of a recent Live Pages event, which featured a brunch and interactive art experience with 2025 Literary Lion Michelle Jing Chan. She also reminded the Board that the final Live Pages event of the year will take place on July 24, featuring Susan Lieu, author of *The Manicurist's Daughter*.



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Finally, Lisa shared details about the upcoming Kick It event with the KCLS Foundation, which will be held in partnership with the Seattle Sounders at Lumen Field on Aug. 24.

Director's Report

Executive Director Heidi Daniel referenced her written report to the board and highlighted a few key topics.

Heidi shared that Summer Reading is off to a strong start, with more than 18,000 sign-ups to date—already surpassing the total number of completions from last year. This indicates significantly higher participation. She extended her appreciation to all staff involved in launching the program and spoke enthusiastically about attending several kickoff events. In particular, she highlighted the Burien launch party, which welcomed more than 400 attendees. Heidi personally assisted at the event, helping children sign up and working the prize wheel.

She also attended the Juneteenth celebration at the Federal Way Library, which saw more than 500 attendees, marking an increase from the previous year. The event featured a variety of activities and was described as a joyful and vibrant community gathering.

Heidi reported on a recent tabletop exercise held at the Bellevue Library to plan for potential disruptions to the central sorter. Approximately 30 leaders from across the Library System participated in discussing various scenarios—including a failure lasting two weeks, two months or until a replacement is acquired. The group identified contingency processes to ensure continued circulation and effective communication with the public. The exercise also clarified the responsibilities of key departments.

Heidi discussed the upcoming Reimagining Library Spaces project. KCLS has engaged Johnston Architects to lead the redesign of select libraries. This work will be informed by findings from the recent accessibility audit, with the goal of creating more inclusive and functional library environments. In addition to updating specific locations, the project aims to develop new systemwide design standards. The five locations selected for initial refreshes are Algona-Pacific, Des Moines, Kent, Southcenter and Mercer Island.

Finally, Heidi referenced the latest dashboard metrics, which were included in the board's packet. She noted their relevance to ongoing planning and service evaluation. She invited questions from the Board.

Board Committee Reports

There were no committee reports.



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Trustees Reports

Trustee Crystal Goodwin updated the board on two recent events she attended: the previously mentioned Juneteenth celebration at the Federal Way Library, and the Awesumm Math Space event at the Skyway Library, an academically engaging program designed for school-aged children.

Adjournment

Laura Valenziano adjourned the meeting at 6:55pm.

Laura Valenziano, President

Jeff Guddat, Secretary
